Listing 10.28 A `query_string` query with an illegal quote character

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "query_string": {
      "query": "title:Java\""
    }
  }
}
```

Query with a syntax error (no corresponding quote)

This query is not parsed. Elasticsearch throws an exception stating that the syntax was violated (`"reason": "Cannot parse 'title:Java\"': Lexical error at line 1, column 12. Encountered: <EOF> after : \"\""`). Throwing this JSON parse exception to the user validates stricter syntax for `query_string` queries. However, if we want Elasticsearch to ignore syntactical errors and continue with the job, there's an alternative: a `simple_query_string` query, discussed in the following section.

10.12 The simple_query_string query

As the name suggests, the `simple_query_string` query is a variant of the `query_string` query with a simple, limited syntax. We can use operators such as `+`, `-`, `|`, `*`, and `~` to construct the query. For example, searching for "Java + Cay" produces a Java book written by Cay, as the next listing shows.

Listing 10.29 A simple_query_string query

```
GET books/_search
{
  "query": {
    "simple_query_string": {
      "query": "Java + Cay"
    }
  }
}
```

Specifies the type of the query as simple_query_string

Searches the query with the AND operator

The `+` operator in the query allows the query to search for "Java" *and* "Cay" across all fields. We can specify the fields if we want to check a set of fields instead of all the fields by setting the `fields` array. Table 10.1 describes the operators we can use in `simple_query_string`.

Table 10.1 Operators for a `simple_query_string` query

Operator	Description
|	OR
+	AND
-	NOT
~	Fuzzy query